

South Korea Technology: Semiconductors – Memory: Takeaways from Korea memory expert call

We hosted a Korea Memory Expert Webinar on July 28. Key takeaways include: 1) DRAM pricing to continue solid growth throughout this year, significant upside for HBM next year, 2) LTA to provide strong binding power, 3) Chinese memory suppliers limited threat in the near-to-mid term, 4) Stronger capacity addition however limited bit growth, and 5) Expects more of a gradual adoption of hybrid bonding. We reiterate our Buy rating on SEC.

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- **DRAM pricing to continue solid growth throughout this year, significant upside for HBM next year:** The expert expects conventional DRAM pricing could see solid double-digit% sequential growth in 3Q26 which is in line with recent strong spot pricing rally. The expert also sees possibility of another double-digit% sequential growth in 4Q26 on the back of ongoing supply shortage. For next year HBM pricing, the expert sees the possibility that pricing could potentially double due to rising conventional DRAM pricing. We expect SEC HBM pricing to rise 87% yoy next year which is above sell-side consensus (Bloomberg) estimate of 52% yoy.
- **LTA to provide strong binding power:** The expert mentioned that LTA includes various terms to enhance binding power such as sizable prepayment, take-or-pay clause, and cancellation penalty. The expert also mentioned more than half of server DRAM is covered by LTA and expects LTA coverage ratio to increase going forward.
- **Chinese memory suppliers limited threat in the near-to-mid term:** The expert mentioned that although Chinese suppliers are active in capacity expansion, expects less likelihood of Chinese suppliers to be a visible threat to leading players as there's still a sizable gap in production yield, technology level, and product reliability.
- **Stronger capacity addition however limited bit growth:** The expert expects the capacity addition pace for this year to be stronger than its historical level, however expects bit growth to be below historical average due to the high HBM trade ratio.
- **Expects more of a gradual adoption of hybrid bonding:** While the expert believes the existing HBM bonding technology will see increasing difficulty as the number of DRAM die stacks increases, at the same time does not expect an early adoption of hybrid bonding as the expert believes securing good enough yield on

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a mass production scale to take a considerable amount of time and effort. The expert believes memory companies will seek various options such as fluxless bonding along with aiming for a gradual adoption of hybrid bonding.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Samsung Electronics

Valuation methodology: Our 12m 2026–2027E EV/EBITDA-based SOTP target price for the common share is W480,000. Our 12-month target price for the preference share is W360,000, which is based on our target pref to common shares discount of 25%, derived from averaging: 1) the pref discount of the 2-factor model and 2) the average preference share discount to common shares during the past 1 month. We are Buy rated on both the common and preference shares.

Key downside risks: 1) major deterioration in memory supply/demand, 2) sharp contraction in smartphone margins, and 3) mobile OLED market share loss.

Investment Thesis – Samsung Electronics

Samsung Electronics (SEC) is one of the largest tech companies in the world, with the #1 market share in several products including memory chips, OLED panels, smartphones, and TVs. We expect the strong earnings power led by memory to continue, supported by our expectation of solid memory pricing continuing and also remaining at an elevated level. We expect this to be helped by the long-term agreements (LTA) with customers, with a higher level of binding commitment likely this time compared to the past. The company is starting to show meaningful progress in HBM, and also considering the higher scope for meaningful shareholder returns, we remain constructive on the name and reiterate our Buy rating.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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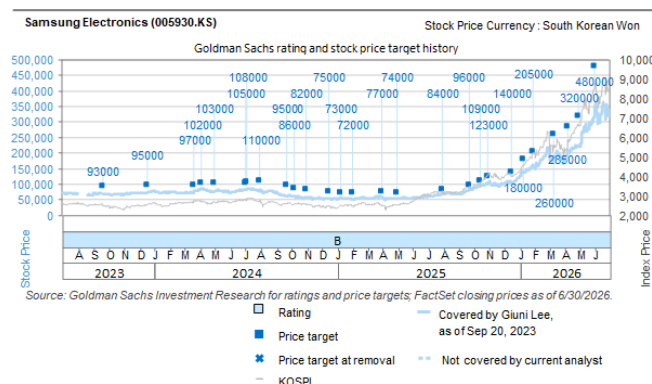
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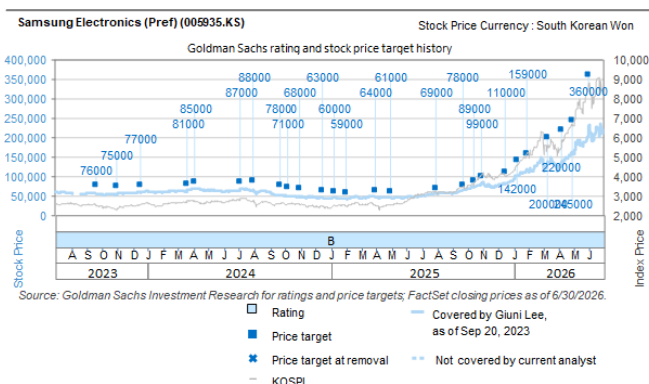
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	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
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Target price history table(s)

Samsung Electronics (Pref) (005935.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
31-May-26	360,000	202,500
30-Apr-26	245,000	158,300
07-Apr-26	220,000	130,900
11-Mar-26	200,000	138,900
29-Jan-26	159,000	115,600
08-Jan-26	142,000	101,900
16-Dec-25	110,000	79,800
30-Oct-25	99,000	82,500
14-Oct-25	89,000	72,300
22-Sep-25	78,000	66,700
31-Jul-25	69,000	57,600
01-May-25	61,000	46,850
01-Apr-25	64,000	47,700
02-Feb-25	59,000	43,000
08-Jan-25	60,000	46,800
16-Dec-24	63,000	46,550
31-Oct-24	68,000	47,950
08-Oct-24	71,000	49,900
23-Sep-24	78,000	52,400
31-Jul-24	88,000	64,900
05-Jul-24	87,000	68,000
05-Apr-24	85,000	69,000
21-Mar-24	81,000	65,800
17-Dec-23	77,000	59,300
31-Oct-23	75,000	53,600
20-Sep-23	76,000	56,100

Samsung Electronics (005930.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
31-May-26	480,000	317,000
30-Apr-26	320,000	220,500
07-Apr-26	285,000	196,500
11-Mar-26	260,000	190,000
29-Jan-26	205,000	160,700
08-Jan-26	180,000	138,800
16-Dec-25	140,000	102,800
30-Oct-25	123,000	104,100
14-Oct-25	109,000	91,600
22-Sep-25	96,000	83,500
31-Jul-25	84,000	71,400
01-May-25	74,000	55,500
01-Apr-25	77,000	58,800
02-Feb-25	72,000	52,400
08-Jan-25	73,000	57,300
16-Dec-24	75,000	55,600
31-Oct-24	82,000	59,200
08-Oct-24	86,000	60,300
23-Sep-24	95,000	62,600
31-Jul-24	110,000	83,900
05-Jul-24	108,000	87,100
01-Jul-24	105,000	81,800
30-Apr-24	103,000	77,500
05-Apr-24	102,000	84,500
21-Mar-24	97,000	79,300
17-Dec-23	95,000	73,300
20-Sep-23	93,000	69,600

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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